

it, engaging firms like Deloitte, EY, and KPMG to identify bottlenecks and blockages. For instance, in Ease of Doing Business rankings, we were 14th; we have jumped to 2nd. In areas like business entry, labour regulation, and land administration, we are now recognised as a top achiever.

Under 'Deregulation Phase One,' we brought in the Uttar Pradesh Sugam Vyapar Sanshodhan Adhiniyam, 2025 (Ease of Doing Business Amendment Act), to reduce compliance burdens. For example, earlier, if a factory boiler burst, the usual response was to send someone to jail. We have moved towards decriminalisation instead, converting such situations into penalties rather than criminal cases. Previous governments seemed more focused on finding ways to jail industrialists or squeeze money out of them. We have pushed firmly in the opposite direction.

84 | We identified the roadblocks and worked to clear them so we can hit our targets. We are constantly asking: where do we need to be by 2030, by 2029, by 2028, by 2027? We just came out of a review meeting where we found we are at 78-80% of a particular target, so the approach is: push the remainder to 100%, and if we hit 90% in one month, the next month's target should be 110%. I would say we are moving firmly and quickly towards a \$1-trillion economy.

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What is the roadmap for attracting companies that are in the business of AI, semiconductors and electronics manufacturing?

About 50-60% of India's mobile phone production happens in UP. It's a huge electronics hub, home to companies like Haier, Amber, Samsung, Lava, and Vivo. In emerging sectors—semiconductors, data centres, defence manufacturing, global capability centres (GCCs), and logistics—we are recognised as a leading state. Foxconn has made a major investment here.

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There's a large UP diaspora abroad, in places like Mauritius. Are they looking to return, given how much UP has changed?

During Covid, many people walked back to their villages on foot. We quarantined them, housed them, fed them, and gave them money before they moved on. We did



skill-mapping, and as new factories and industries came up, we supplied them as manpower accordingly.

Our NRI department also helps people who want to work abroad, matching their skills and language training to the destination. For instance, if someone wants to go to Japan, we train them in Japanese language first. Our labour department is driving this. Law and order used to be the biggest problem. We have cracked down on criminals. As a result, people's trust and confidence in UP has grown, and that is drawing in industry.

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As Industries Minister, what investment do you expect over the next 5-10 years?

At our Global Investors Summit, we received MoUs worth about ₹33.5 lakh crore. That figure has since crossed ₹50 lakh crore. Signing an MoU isn't a legal commitment; there's no penalty if a project does not go ahead. But even so, a substantial share of that ₹33.5 lakh crore has converted into real, on-the-ground projects. **BT**

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